

[Return to Search](#)


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Original Page: 390-392b

Culture (OWC): [Azande \(F007\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Central Africa

Field Date: 1926-1929

Coverage Date: 1926-1929

## Place Coverage

Nili-Uelle Divide, Democratic Republic of the Congo

Section Title(S): Untitled Section

He passes on to see this elder brother of his father and says to him: 'Father, it is you I have come to see because that fellow over there, that blood-brother of mine, said yesterday that you were dead. '

522  
Humor

608  
Artificial Kin  
Relationships

To which the old man replies, rather offended: 'Hm! so when you heard that you believed it, did you? The fellow is a fool to play such jokes. If he tells you something, just reply, 'Really, is that so?' Now, my son, what little thing is the matter with me that I should die from it, eh? So! if I were ill wouldn't your elder brother send some one to you to summon you to come and see the evil that was happening to your father? Jests of this kind are no good, my son; if you don't know all about these jokes beforehand, you put your foot into the fire. '

522  
Humor

608  
Artificial Kin  
Relationships

'It is thus they say about jests of this kind: if some one with whom you are on joking terms comes with a long sad face to tell you some story about your relatives such as 'Don't you know that your relative has died?' you should take care not to be caught. He is jesting about your relative saying that he is dead, and you must not be taken in. Blood-jests, they say, are awful lies.

522  
Humor

608  
Artificial Kin  
Relationships

'Then when he meets him again in the path he says to him, 'Ah, friend! You did play me a rotten trick. I went ever such a far distance. Friend, may some one spear you!' The man who has played the joke bursts with laughter and says, 'Ho ho ho, so friend, ha ho ha ha, isn't he dead after all? Ha! while you were with this other father of yours [390-392c](#) have you heard this latest bit of news of mine, that father of yours who lives quite near has been bitten by a

522  
Humor

608  
Artificial Kin  
Relationships

snake. I saw that child of his, the girl, wailing the wail of death, buba zoga re  
ooo, ako buba te, ako buba te. '

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